

P08 – AI-Powered Research Assistant

Group Formal Tag: SOFT3888_TU08_01

Tutor Name: Michael de Francesco

Client Name: Bocheng Han

Group members details

(indicate if any member is doing multiple units)

No.	Student Name	Student ID	Student Unikey	XP-Roles
1	Joshua Morton	530500735	jmor4801	Programmer
2	Prithish Lahiri	530609175	plah4259	Doomsayer, Programmer
3	Fiona Lee	540880966	flee0409	Manager, Programmer
4	Kang Le Charles Lim	540375026	klim0039	Customer Liaison, Programmer
5	Felicia Chen	530532079	lche6131	Tracker, Programmer
6	Xiyuan Pan	530667566	xpan0988	Tester, Programmer
7	Xingyu Liu	510015523	xliu3209	Coach, Programmer

Attendances: *Joshua Morton, Prithish Lahiri, Fiona Lee, Kang Le Charles Lim, Felicia Chen, Xiyuan Pan, Xingyu Liu*

Apologies: *None*

Submission Date: 23/8/2026

Weekly Group Meeting Minutes

Time: 18 Aug 2026, the 1st group meeting in week 3, in workshop

Venue: J02.03.315 PNR Building Learning Studio 315

Meeting Minute Taker: Felicia Chen

#	Agenda Item	Description/ Comments	Decision/Action	Who?	Items for escalation
1	What has been completed?	The team had previously prepared a structured list of questions for the client meeting, organised into different categories.	Keep the existing categorised question list and include the newly identified questions in the next client meeting.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.
2	What is in progress?	The original client was temporarily unavailable, so the team has been reassigned to another contact from the same company. The team is currently working on establishing communication with the new client and arranging the first meeting.	Contact the new client, introduce the team and project, and arrange a suitable meeting time.	Everyone	Client contact and meeting availability need to be confirmed.
3	What is working well?	The team has already organised the questions that need to be clarified with the	Continue using the categorised question list as the main	Everyone	No immediate escalation.

		client into categories. This should make the upcoming client meeting more structured and reduce the risk of missing important requirements.	structure for the client meeting.		
4	What needs improvement?	Since the client contact has changed, some of the previously planned communication needs to be re-established. The team also needs to avoid making assumptions about requirements before confirming them with the new client.	Reconfirm the project scope, priorities, expected functionality and constraints with the new client before making major implementation decisions.	Everyone	Confirmation from the new client is required before finalising requirements
5	Reminders	The new client may not yet be familiar with the team's previous discussions or preparation. The team should therefore provide a concise project overview during the first meeting and explain the purpose of the questions.	Prepare a short introduction to the project and ensure all team members are familiar with the key questions before the meeting.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.

6	What needs to be completed before the next meeting?	The team needs to establish contact with the new client, confirm the meeting time, review the existing question list, and add the newly identified questions.	Finalise the categorised question list and prepare it for discussion during the client meeting.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.
7	What's Next	The immediate priority is to reconnect with the client and clarify the project requirements. After the meeting, the team will update the project scope, requirements and implementation priorities based on the client's responses.	Arrange the client meeting first, then update project documentation and task allocation based on confirmed requirements.	Everyone	Requirements and scope may need to change after client feedback
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Main Discussions

The team discussed the change in client contact. The original client was temporarily unavailable, and the team has therefore been reassigned to another contact person from the same company. As a result, the immediate priority is to establish communication with the new client and arrange a suitable time for the first meeting. The team also reviewed the questions that had already been prepared for the client. These questions have been organised into different categories to make the meeting more structured and ensure that important aspects of the system requirements are covered.

Several additional questions were identified and added to the list:

- Besides the number of clicks or views, are there other quantitative metrics that could be used to rank or evaluate papers?
- Should the system provide a paper download function?

- How should papers that require payment or subscription access be handled?
- Are there any restrictions or preferred approaches regarding access to paywalled academic papers?

The team agreed that these questions should be clarified with the new client before making assumptions about the final system design and implementation.

Key Takeaways

- *The change of client contact means that the team needs to re-establish communication.*
- *The categorised question list will be used to structure the upcoming client meeting.*
- *The definition of an authoritative/trustworthy paper needs to be clarified before the team finalises the paper-ranking approach.*
- *The team should investigate quantitative ranking signals beyond simple click or view counts, subject to client requirements.*
- *The team needs to clarify whether paper downloading is within the project scope.*
- *The team needs to clarify how the system should handle papers that are behind paywalls or require subscriptions.*
- *The team should avoid making major technical or implementation assumptions until the client's expectations have been confirmed.*

What Happened

- From last week, the team completed the preparation and categorisation of questions for the client meeting. However, the original client was temporarily unavailable, and the team was reassigned to another contact person from the same company. Therefore, the planned client discussion could not proceed as originally expected.
- The task of establishing communication with the new client and arranging a meeting has been carried over and is now the team's immediate priority.
- The existing questions have been retained and several new questions have been added, particularly regarding paper authority, quantitative ranking metrics, downloading papers, and handling paywalled papers

What's Next

- ☐ Josh Morton is responsible for contacting the newly assigned client and arranging a suitable time for the first client meeting.
- ☐ Felicia is responsible for recording the client's responses during the meeting and ensuring that confirmed requirements are reflected in the project documentation.

Weekly Group Meeting Minutes

Time: 22 Aug 2026, the 2st group meeting in week 3, out of class

Venue: Instagram call

Meeting Minute Taker: Felicia Chen

#	Agenda Item	Description/ Comments	Decision/Action	Who?	Items for escalation
1	What has been completed?	The first client meeting was completed. The team discussed and clarified the initial project scope and requirements with the client. The team completed preliminary research on the project, company and potential technical approaches. The team began consolidating the confirmed requirements into the Project Proposal and Scope Statement.	Use the client meeting outcomes to refine the project scope and technical direction. Continue preparing the Project Proposal and Scope Statement. Begin planning the initial MVP and development milestones.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.
2	What is in progress?	Finalising the project scope, SMART objectives	Divide the remaining proposal and presentation	Everyone	Further clarification may be required if technical

		and success criteria. Preparing the initial technical architecture. Preparing the Project Proposal and Scope Statement. Preparing for the Project Proposal and Roles Allocation presentation.	tasks among group members. Complete the required documentation before the Week 3 deadline.		constraints or data access issues are identified.
3	What is working well?	The first client meeting helped clarify the project direction and reduce uncertainty from Week 2. The team has established a clearer understanding of the project scope and expected deliverables. Group members are contributing to the proposal and planning tasks.	Continue regular communication and task tracking to ensure the Week 3 deliverables are completed on time.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.
4	What needs improvement?	The project has a broad scope and several technical components, including data collection, search,	Prioritise the core MVP features first. Treat GraphRAG as a later	Everyone	Potential data availability and API limitations may affect the

		ranking, RAG and GraphRAG. The team needs to prioritise the core MVP before implementing more complex features. Individual tasks and deadlines need to be tracked closely because multiple deliverables are due during the early stages of the project.	feature and maintain a simpler RAG-based approach as a fallback if required.		data collection strategy. GraphRAG feasibility should be monitored as the project progresses.
5	Reminders	The MVP should focus on plain-English search, academic profiles and basic filtering. Computer Science and Information Technology should be prioritised for data coverage and structural accuracy. AI-generated answers should provide supporting sources and avoid unsupported claims.	Keep the scope manageable and prioritise core functionality before additional features.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.

6	What needs to be completed before the next meeting?	Project Proposal and Scope Statement; SMART objectives and success criteria; initial technical architecture; role allocation and responsibilities; initial development plan; presentation preparation.	Complete assigned sections and review the combined document before submission.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.
7	What's Next	Complete the Project Proposal and Scope Statement. Complete the Project Proposal and Roles Allocation presentation. Finalise the initial development plan and task allocation. Begin preparation for the first development sprint.	Finalise the documentation and presentation. Prepare to begin data collection and initial system development.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.
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Main Discussions

- The team held the first client meeting and discussed the project requirements, scope and expected outcomes.
- The project will focus on discovering Australian researchers and research expertise across selected Australian universities.
- The team discussed using plain-English search to help users discover relevant researchers and academic information.
- The initial MVP will prioritise core features such as academic search, researcher profiles and filtering.
- Computer Science and Information Technology will be prioritised for data quality and coverage.
- The team discussed the importance of source grounding and citation traceability for AI-generated answers.
- GraphRAG was discussed as a potential advanced retrieval approach, with a simpler RAG-based approach available as a fallback if necessary.

Key Takeaways

- The first client meeting clarified the project's initial direction and scope.
- The project should prioritise a manageable MVP before implementing more complex features.
- Academic data collection and data quality will be important parts of the project.
- CS/IT will be prioritised for stronger and more structured data coverage.
- AI-generated information should be supported by sources, and the system should avoid unsupported claims.
- The technical approach should remain flexible while considering the feasibility of GraphRAG.

What Happened

- The project scope and initial requirements were further clarified.
- The team started preparing the Project Proposal and Scope Statement based on the clarified project direction.

What's Next

- ☐ Felicia Chen is responsible for maintaining the project meeting minutes, tracking individual progress and reminding members of upcoming deliverables and deadlines. Deliverable: Updated project progress records.
- ☐ Felicia Chen is responsible for coordinating the overall project progress and ensuring that team tasks are completed according to the agreed timeline. Deliverable: Updated task tracking.

- ☐ Joshua Morton is responsible for investigating OpenAlex, ORCID and Crossref and developing an initial data collection approach. Deliverable: Initial data source investigation and data collection plan.
- ☐ Prithish Lahiri is responsible for preparing the initial frontend structure and identifying the main user flows. Deliverable: Initial wireframes or frontend structure for the MVP.
- ☐ Xingyu Liu is responsible for defining the initial researcher profile structure and identifying the information required for the Australian Researcher Directory. Deliverable: Initial researcher profile data schema.
- ☐ Fiona Lee is responsible for investigating and proposing the database structure for storing researcher, publication and relationship data. Deliverable: Initial database schema and technology recommendation.
- ☐ Kang Le Charles Lim is responsible for proposing the initial backend/API architecture. Deliverable: Initial backend architecture design.
- ☐ Felicia Chen is responsible for investigating potential approaches for semantic search, keyword search and paper ranking. Deliverable: Initial search and ranking design proposal.
- ☐ Xiyuan Pan is responsible for investigating the feasibility of RAG and GraphRAG for the project. Deliverable: Technical comparison and initial recommendation for RAG/GraphRAG.

Weekly Client Meeting Minutes

Time: 20/8/2026, 5:30pm

Venue: google meeting

Meeting Minute Taker: Felicia Chen

Attendances: Joshua Morton, Prithish Lahiri, Fiona Lee, Kang Le Charles Lim, Felicia Chen, Xiyuan Pan, Xingyu Liu

Apologies: None

#	Agenda Item	Description/ Comments	Decision/Action	Who?	Items for escalation
1	What has been completed?	The team completed the first client meeting and introduced the team members, their experience and interests. The project scope and main functions, including the Australian Researcher Directory, paper discovery and ranking, and AI-assisted research functions, were discussed.	Record the outcomes of the client meeting and use them to refine the project scope and proposal.	Everyone	Follow-up may be required for questions that were not fully resolved during the meeting.
2	What is in progress?	The team is refining the project scope, requirements and technical direction based on the client meeting. The Project Proposal	Continue consolidating the confirmed requirements and identify remaining assumptions	Everyone	No immediate escalation.

		and Scope Statement are also in progress.	and open questions.		
3	What is working well?	The preliminary research and questions prepared in Week 2 helped the team conduct the first client meeting. The team was able to discuss the project from project, legal, software and budget perspectives.	Continue preparing questions in advance and documenting key decisions and unresolved issues after each meeting.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.
4	What needs improvement?	The project has a broad scope, and not all requirements could be finalised during the first client meeting. Some questions require further clarification, particularly regarding data access, full-text papers, performance requirements and infrastructure.	Prioritise the core MVP and follow up on unresolved questions with the client when necessary.	Everyone	Data access restrictions, paywalled papers, hosting, LLM costs and performance requirements may affect the final design.
5	Reminders	The system should provide supporting references and distinguish source-supported information from	Keep these requirements in mind when defining the search, ranking and AI-assisted	Everyone	No immediate escalation.

		model-generated interpretation. Citation count should not be treated as the only measure of research importance or quality.	research functions.		
6	What needs to be completed before the next meeting?	The team needs to update the Project Proposal and Scope Statement based on the client meeting. The team also needs to finalise the initial project scope, objectives, success criteria, technical direction and role allocation.	Complete assigned sections and consolidate the project documentation before the next meeting.	Everyone	The expected definition and evaluation of foundational and influential publications may require further clarification.
7	What's Next	Continue preparing the project proposal and initial development plan. Follow up on any unresolved client questions and prepare for the next project phase.	Complete the required Week 3 deliverables and finalise the initial project direction.	Everyone	No immediate escalation.
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Main Discussions

- The client and team members introduced themselves and briefly discussed their experience and interests.

- The project was introduced and the overall purpose of the AI-powered Research Assistant was discussed.
- The team discussed citation support for generated responses and whether the citation format could be selected by the team.
- The team discussed potential data sources and API-based data collection. OpenAlex were identified as potential data sources.
- The team discussed that the database technology could be selected by the group based on the project requirements.
- The team discussed the possible use of RAG and GraphRAG and the need to determine the most suitable retrieval approach.
- The team discussed whether international literature should be included in the paper discovery function.
- The team raised questions regarding ranking factors, including semantic relevance, citation influence and publication recency.
- The team discussed whether graph visualisation would be a core user-facing feature or an optional feature.
- The team raised questions regarding deployment, performance, security, hosting, LLM API usage and project budget.

Key Takeaways

- The team is expected to identify and obtain appropriate public or licensed academic data rather than receiving a dataset from the client.
- OpenAlex, ORCID and Crossref can be considered as potential data sources for the project.
- The team has flexibility in selecting the database and software architecture, subject to the project requirements.
- The final technical approach for RAG and GraphRAG should be selected based on the feasibility and needs of the project.
- The system should provide supporting references for generated answers and clearly distinguish source-supported information from model-generated interpretation.
- Citation count should not be treated as the only indicator of research importance or quality.

- Further decisions may still be required regarding data access, full-text availability, performance requirements, deployment, hosting, budget and evaluation metrics.

What Happened

- The first client meeting was completed in Week 3 after the project allocation was confirmed.
- The team presented the questions prepared during Week 2 and used the meeting to clarify the project's purpose, scope and possible technical directions.
- The outcomes of the meeting will be used to refine the project scope, technical direction and Project Proposal and Scope Statement.

What's Next

- Xingyu Liu is responsible for coordinating the follow-up actions from the client meeting.
- Everyone is responsible for consolidating the clarified project requirements into the Project Proposal and Scope Statement.
- Felicia Chen is responsible for updating the Week 3 meeting documentation and tracking the completion of individual tasks and deliverables following the client meeting.

Individual Progress Report

Name: Xiyuan Pan

Student ID:530667566

Unikey:xpan0988

Goals

- Clarify project requirements with the client.
- Contribute to defining the project scope and proposal.
- Investigate GraphRAG, academic data collection and LLM requirements.
- Identify key technical decisions required before implementation.

Progress Made

- Reviewed the updated client specification and identified confirmed scope, functional requirements, deliverables and evaluation criteria.
- Clarified that GraphRAG and research-material download functionality are required, while most technical implementation choices are left to the team.
- Identified the lack of budget for paid LLM APIs as an important technical constraint and investigated possible zero-cost approaches.
- Drafted parts of the project proposal, including the Project Aim, Project Scope and Out of Scope and sections 3.3–3.6 of the project proposal, covering high-level architecture, feasibility, testing and deployment
- Investigated academic data collection and source-traceability requirements, including the choice between storing publication content and metadata/source-link-based retrieval.
- Considered how previously developed and tested graph infrastructure could potentially be adapted for the required GraphRAG component.

Blockers to Progress/Issues

- The LLM provider and remaining backend deployment details still need to be finalised, particularly because no budget has been allocated for paid LLM APIs.
- The exact GraphRAG implementation and relationship model still require further technical design and testing.
- The handling of publication full text versus metadata/source-link-based retrieval still requires confirmation or a final team decision.

Name: Fiona Lee

Student ID: 540880966

Goals

- Clarify project scope with the client
- Agree on tech stack decisions
- Finish preparing for the week 4 presentation

Progress Made

- Clarified project scope and details with the client
- Finished project scope and proposal
- Decided on tech stack decisions and proposal details

Blockers to Progress/Issues

- Setting up an initial meeting with the client was delayed as there was miscommunication from the client
- Quite a lot of research needs to be done in a short span of time due to the delay from the client

Name: Prithish Lahiri

Student ID: 530609175

Goals:

- ⇒ clarify scope and doubts regarding paywalled content with client
- ⇒ clarify any additional requirements other than the ones on campus
- ⇒ discuss tech stack, database and deployment based decisions with teammates
- ⇒ finish project proposal report and slides

Progress Made:

- ⇒ clarified questions with client
- ⇒ done with proposal slides and report

Blockers to Progress/Issues: getting a common time for all group members to meet

Name: Joshua Morton

Student ID: 530500735

Goals

- To help decide which tech stack tools to use throughout the project
- Communicate with Client to organise an initial meeting
- Help contribute to the progress report
- Help create google slides for the project proposal

Progress Made

- Was able to organise a meeting for the group with the client
- Met with group members twice to discuss which tools would be best for use in our project
- Helped research whether we should use RAG vs GraphRAG, and which database tool would be best to implement
- Wrote the abstract for the Project Scope and Proposal
- Completed the roles and responsibilities for the Project Scope and Proposal
- Completed the slides for the aims and objectives, project scope, and tech stack
- Helped establish GitHub rules so that pushing directly to main is prohibited in order to reduce any mistakes

Blockers to Progress/Issues

- The client cancelled the first plan for the initial meeting a few hours beforehand
- There was confusion between which person would be our client, however eventually a time was organised
- Was unable to attend the planned initial meeting due to University clashes however caught up on the meeting
- The client provided very vague and blurry guidelines to the project which lengthened the time it took us to plan the project

Name: Xingyu Liu

Student ID:510015523

Goals

- Contribute to the Week 3 Project Proposal, focusing on the non-technical sections (Introduction, Aims, Scope) and select technical-support sections.
- Participate in the first client meeting and contribute to clarifying project requirements.
- Clarify open questions from the team regarding technical direction, deployment, and role allocation ahead of the proposal deadline.
- Support the team's understanding of what remains outstanding before submission.

Progress Made

- Attended and participated in the first client meeting, contributing to discussion and clarification of project requirements alongside the team.
- Drafted the Introduction and Context section of the Project Proposal, describing the project background and motivation in non-technical language.
- Drafted the Project Aims and Objectives, and the Scope / Out of Scope sections, aligned with the client's updated specification and Tutor notes template.
- Drafted Section 3.1 Data Collection, covering data sourcing strategy (official university pages as primary source, OpenAlex/ORCID/Crossref as supplementary), handling of duplicated/conflicting data, and the approach to paywalled content.
- Drafted Section 4.1 Resources Needed, listing required software, API access, AI/computational resources, and hosting/deployment resources.
- Drafted a preliminary Risk Assessment table (Section 6) and the Implications section (5.2), to be reviewed and expanded by the team.
- Identified and raised a discrepancy between the client contact listed in earlier meeting minutes (Bocheng Han) and the updated Tutor notes (Vecton AI, Harry Ye), flagged to the team for clarification.
- Compiled a consolidated list of outstanding technical and organisational decisions the team needs to confirm before submission (tech stack, RAG vs GraphRAG, deployment platform, data collection priority, role rotation for Weeks 4–5).

Blockers to Progress/Issues

- The technical architecture section (3.2–3.6) and Milestones/Schedule section (7) remain blocked pending team decisions on backend framework, database type, RAG vs GraphRAG, and deployment platform.

- The updated Tutor notes template lists GraphRAG explicitly within the required project scope, which conflicts with the team's earlier informal discussion of treating GraphRAG as optional — this needs to be resolved before the Scope section can be finalised with full confidence.
- Role allocation for Weeks 4–5, including my own role, has not yet been decided by the team.
- Some risk items and data-source questions are dependent on client clarification and cannot be fully resolved internally.

Name: Kang Le Charles Lim

Student ID: 540375026

Goals

This week's goals are to meet the client to clarify project specifications with him and to discuss with the group on the project's direction.

Progress Made

Met with client to discuss more on project's specification and attended this week meeting minutes.

Blockers to Progress/Issues

There was a slight delay in meeting up with the client. There are still uncertainties regarding the project's direction as not much information and resources are given aside from the criteria and requirements.

Name: Felicia Chen

Student ID: 530532079

Goals

- *Ensure every group member is included and progressing with their assigned tasks.*
- *Coordinate team progress and prepare for the initial client meeting.*
- *Maintain project progress records and track upcoming deliverables and deadlines.*
- *Contribute to initial project planning and role allocation for the next development phase.*
- *Onboard the new team member and ensure a smooth integration into the group workflow.*

Progress Made

- *Completed and consolidated the Week 3 project and client meeting minutes.*
- *Maintained the project meeting records and tracked the progress of individual group members.*
- *Reminded team members of upcoming deliverables and deadlines to ensure they had sufficient time to complete their assigned tasks.*
- *Coordinated the overall project progress and helped ensure that team tasks were progressing according to the agreed timeline.*
- *Updated the project task tracking records.*
- *Completed the Milestones / Schedule section of the project progress documentation by developing a phased project plan and defining the major milestones and expected deliverables.*
- *Participated in the planning and allocation of tasks and responsibilities for the following two weeks.*
- *Contributed to the initial role allocation and development planning for the next project phase.*
- *Onboarded the new team member: Added he to all relevant group communication channels (e.g., messaging groups, shared drives, and documentation platforms). Provided an overview of the project background, current progress, and key deliverables. Shared access to all essential documents. Briefed him on the upcoming client meeting schedule and prepared them for participation. Addressed initial questions and ensured they felt supported and ready to contribute.*

Blockers to Progress/Issues

- *The project has a broad scope, and several technical and project requirements still need to be clarified as the project moves into the development phase.*
- *Coordinating tasks and schedules across 7 group members requires continuous progress tracking and early communication regarding upcoming deadlines.*
- *Some task dependencies and technical responsibilities may need to be adjusted as the team begins the first development sprint.*